

7.2.2 CNET.com

CNET is probably the most well-known review site in the world. It offers so much more than reviews, though, and if we started listing out all it offers, we'll waste quite a few pages of this book. The solution is simple really, just type in www.cnet.com into your browser and let yourself be



The CNET Home Page.

dazzled by the sheer volumes of information that is available in categories such as—tech news, blogs, interesting articles, CNET TV, etc.

Reviews are, obviously, the prime focus on CNET, and almost all products have a video review—which is short: to give you an idea of what the product looks and feels like—and a long, well-detailed text review to tell everything you need to know about the product. The reviews are well-written, and bring out all the pros and cons of the hardware in question. CNET scores on a scale of 10, so anything that's rated 8 and above should be a spectacular product—CNET has really high standards.

As we mentioned earlier, Tom's Hardware is all about PC components... CNET is all about everything else. It focuses on gadgets and stand-alone devices such as cell phones, MP3 players and HDTVs. CNET has several sister sites—CNET Asia, CNET UK and CNET Australia, to give you content that's relevant to your area. CNET Asia is well known for its Mobile Phone reviews.

The CNET interface is top-of-the-line, and you *know* when you're browsing through the site that it was well planned and expensive to build! The interface is the perfect balance of eye-candy, and usability. Make sure you check out the blogs once you are done reading the reviews. There are several blogs like The Audiophiliac, an audio-oriented blog which is maintained by Donald Bell, one of CNET's senior editors. These blogs are great sources for in-depth information on any particular subject. Another must-visit.